

MARKET INTELLIGENCE

How This Really Sells

The honest, numbers-backed playbook for turning the course into revenue

The one honest truth

Digital products do not sell themselves, and marketplaces do not make you rich.

The money that moves fastest is **funded delivery to buyers who already have the budget allocated** — Dutch schools and Erasmus+ providers. The download products are a compounding asset underneath, not the first income. Sequence it that way and this works; do it backwards (build a shop, wait for strangers) and it stalls.

Ranked by speed-to-cash and fit:

1. Funded Dutch in-school PD — the budget already exists, per teacher.
2. Erasmus+ — funded, international, list for free where schools look.
3. Self-hosted digital sales — best margin, but slow without an audience.
4. Marketplaces (Udemy/TPT) — reach and credibility, not margin.

Engine 1 · Funded Dutch in-school PD (start here)

Why it's first: the money is already in the building.

- Every PO teacher has an individual professionaliseringsbudget of €500/yr (+ 2 hrs/week). Every VO teacher: €600/yr (+ 83 hrs/yr).
- On top: €300M/yr structural werkdrukkiddelen in VO, half for individual use.
- Plus the pots we already target: CmK cultuurgeld and the structural basisvaardigheden / digitale-geletterdheid money.

What this means concretely:

- A €59 mini-course fits inside a single teacher's own budget — no committee.
- A team of 10 buying the mini-course, or a school licence (€249-549), is a rounding error against a school's professionalisering line.
- A live study day (€2,400-3,600) is normal spend for a studiedag, and the materials make one trainer look like an institute.

How to actually close it:

- Sell into the warm leads already in the pipeline (SWV's, Agora schools, Cultuur Oost, OOE, the new gamification-believer schools). They know Kevin.
- Lead with the outcome and the funding line named: "one study day, funded from your basisvaardigheden or professionalisering budget, and your team keeps the materials." Naming the budget removes the "we have no money" reflex.
- Offer the team licence as the default upsell after any single sale.

Realistic first numbers: 3-5 study days over a school year (€8k-15k) plus a handful of team licences is a credible, low-effort base — all from existing

relationships.

Engine 2 · Erasmus+ (funded, international, free to list)

The economics (real figures):

- Teachers attend on 100% Erasmus+ funding; providers charge roughly €400-500 per participant per week.
- An invited trainer delivering on-site is paid around €250/day (Europass benchmark); negotiate €250-400/day for a specialist 2-day course, or license the course to a provider for a flat fee.
- Erasmus+ pays participants €80/day toward course fees (max €800/project), so a ~€400-560/week course sits right inside the grant.

The free discovery channel most people miss:

- List the course yourself on the European School Education Platform (school-education.ec.europa.eu). Independent providers list on-site Erasmus+ courses for free; schools across Europe search it to build mobilities. No gatekeeper, no fee. Register as an organisation, publish the course, pick dates.

How to actually close it:

- Two tracks in parallel: (a) list on ESEP for inbound, and (b) **pitch providers** to add the course or take Kevin as a trainer (drafts already sent to Delightex, Europass Teacher Academy, Primera).
 - The Delightex Training Partner / Ambassador route is the on-brand shortcut: it puts Kevin in front of the platform's international school base.
- Realistic first numbers: one provider partnership or a couple of ESEP-sourced groups = €2k-6k per delivered week, recurring each season.

Engine 3 · Self-hosted digital sales (the compounding asset)

The platform math (real fees):

- Gumroad: 10% + \$0.50 per sale, but it is now Merchant of Record (handles EU VAT for you) and its Discover marketplace brings some traffic. Best to start here with no audience.
- Payhip: 5% + has a course builder and quizzes; move here at scale (~€3k/mo) when lower fees beat Gumroad's traffic.

The conversion reality (so we don't kid ourselves):

- Opt-in / landing pages convert at 3-5% (top creators 8-15%).

- Sales pages convert at 1-3% (top 5-10%).
- Email drives 30-40% of course revenue — the list is the asset, not the page.
- Niche targeting lifts conversion 6-8x; "transformation over content" framing ~3x. Our niche (gamification + AI + inclusion/special needs) is exactly the kind of specificity that converts.

What this implies: at a €59 price and a 3% sales-page rate, ~€3k/month needs ~1,700 visitors or a warm email list around 1,000. That list does not exist yet, so digital income is a build, not a switch. Start it now, expect it to matter in months, not weeks.

How to actually build it:

- Put the course on Gumroad; put the free "6 Levers" lead magnet on the landing page to collect emails.
- Run the 30-day "keep playing" email sequence; email is where the sales are.
- Add testimonials from the first live groups (proof is the single biggest lever); use a time-limited launch window for each cohort.

Engine 4 · Marketplaces (reach, not margin)

- Udemy gamification courses pull big enrolments (4k-20k students) but at heavily discounted €15-50 prices — a race to the bottom. Use a lite version for discovery and credibility, funnelling to the full course on your own site.
- Teachers Pay Teachers / Gumroad Discover: list a few cheap assets (a levers poster, an AI-prompt pack, a Delightex starter brief) that are useful alone and advertise the course. TPT paid out ~\$253M to sellers in 2024, but earnings are very uneven — treat it as a lead channel, not income.
- Competitors exist (Gabe Zichermann, generic UX-gamification courses) but almost none combine education + AI + Delightex + inclusion. That gap is the wedge.

What actually converts (the levers, in order)

1. Proof. Testimonials, completion stories, "delivered to international teacher groups." Get 3 quotes from the first live groups and put them everywhere.
2. Transformation, not features. Sell "your team leaves with a finished, playable lesson," not "12 modules." ~3x conversion difference.
3. A free, genuinely useful sample. The 6-Levers one-pager; it collects emails.
4. Niche specificity. Lead with inclusion / special-needs gamification — nobody else does, and specificity multiplies conversion.

5. Name the funding. Every pitch says which existing budget pays for it.
6. Email + urgency. A sequence and a time-limited window; email is 30-40% of sales.

The 30 / 60 / 90 to first real money

Days 0-30 — turn on the funded engines

- Put the course + mini-courses on a Gumroad checkout; add the lead magnet.
- List the course on the European School Education Platform (free).
- Offer a study day to the 3 warmest school/SWV leads, funding line named.
- Send the 3 international provider drafts; apply to Delightex Ambassador.

Days 30-60 — proof and repeat

- Deliver the first study day; collect 3 testimonials and a photo/quote.
- Put testimonials on both landing pages; launch a time-limited mini-course push to the Dutch list via LinkedIn + email.
- Follow up every provider reply; convert one to a booked delivery.

Days 60-90 — compound

- Publish 2-3 marketplace assets (Udemy lite + TPT/Gumroad) pointing home.
- Start the weekly "onderwijs vanuit de tourbus" LinkedIn thread (audience = the digital engine's fuel).
- Package the school/team licence as the default upsell; pitch a workshop to a CIS/ECIS conference for 2026.

Do-this-first (five actions)

1. Gumroad checkout live for the full course + 3 mini-courses.
2. List on school-education.ec.europa.eu (free Erasmus+ discovery).
3. One study day booked from a warm lead, funded from their PD budget.
4. Send the 3 provider drafts + apply to Delightex Ambassador.
5. Lead magnet on the landing page, start collecting emails.

KEY POINT

The whole strategy in one line: sell funded delivery to people who already know you and already have the budget, use that to gather proof and an email list, and let the digital products compound underneath. Fast money first, asset second.

What we still want to collect (next intel)

- Exact ESEP registration steps and any provider/accreditation requirement.
- Dutch nascholingsregister / validated-hours status (does certification add value?).

- Two or three real competitor price points for a comparable education gamification course (not UX), to sharpen our €149.
- Whether a Delightex Ambassador gets referrals or just a badge (affects effort).